
SWEET
TREATS

Sweet Treats

Everyone needs a little sweet treat every once in a while. And dessert can be part of a healthy diet—in moderation. These yummy recipes incorporate some healthier ingredients, like fruit, whole grains, beans, less sugar, and less fat.

Fruit Crumble

Filling:
7 ½ cup sliced fruit (peaches, plums, apricots, berries, apples, apricots, pears, etc.)
3 tbsp. sugar
3 tbsp. whole wheat flour
3 tbsp. orange juice

Topping:
1 ½ cup rolled oats
¾ cup chopped nuts
½ cup brown sugar
1/3 cup whole wheat flour
¾ tsp cinnamon
5 tbsp. olive oil

1. Preheat oven to 400°F. Lightly oil a 9 x 13 inch baking dish and set aside.
2. Combine filling ingredients in a large bowl, stirring to combine well. Pour into the baking dish.
3. In the bowl you mixed the fruit in, combine the topping ingredients. Pour over the fruit and make sure that it covers most of the fruit pieces.
4. Bake for 20-25 minutes or until bubbling and golden brown.
5. Serve warm with fresh cream or a dollop of ice cream. This is also very tasty just as it is!

Recipe adapted from Tamara Steinitz



Healthy Rice Pudding

1/3 cup sugar
2 tbsp. corn starch
2 eggs
2 cups milk (skim, 1%, 2%, soy, or nut milks all work great)
2 cups cooked rice (using brown rice will add extra flavor and fiber)
¼ cup raisins or other dried fruit (optional)
1 tsp vanilla

1. Whisk sugar, cornstarch, and eggs together in a medium-sized, heavy-bottomed saucepan.
2. Add milk, rice, and raisins (if desired) and heat over medium heat until thickened, stirring often. Remove from the heat and stir in vanilla.
3. Serve warm or cold, according to your preference.

Recipe adapted from Sheryl Aguilar

Baked Apples

4 large baking apples (Granny Smith, Golden Delicious, Jonathon, Jonagold, or Rome Beauty)
¼ cup brown sugar
1 tsp cinnamon
¼ cup chopped pecans (optional)
¼ cup chopped dried fruit (cranberries, raisins, dates, currants, etc.)
1 tbsp. butter
¾ cup boiling water or apple juice

1. Preheat oven to 375°F. Wash apples. Remove cores leaving ½ inch of the bottom still intact. Make sure that you remove the seeds as you cut out the core. Make the holes ¾ to 1 inch wide. This is where the filling will go so make it wide enough, but don't cut through the bottom of the apples.
2. In a small bowl, combine the sugar, cinnamon, dried fruit, and pecans. Place the apples in a square baking dish (8x8 or 9x9 both work well). Stuff each apple with the filling mixture and top each with a dot of butter (about 1 tsp for each).
3. Add boiling water or apple juice to the baking dish and cover with foil. Bake for 30-40 minutes, until the apples are tender, but not mushy. Remove the dish from the over and baste the apples with the pan juices several times. Serve warm with vanilla ice cream, whipped cream, or vanilla yogurt if desired.

Recipe adapted from simplyrecipes.com

Heart Healthy Cookies

What makes these cookies heart healthy? Beans. Yes, beans! Beans are high in fiber and are a great source of plant based protein. They are used in this recipe to replace the fat, making it a more heart healthy dessert. Sounds a little weird, right? Don't worry, these cookies are so tasty, you'll easily forget that they have beans in them.

¾ cup mashed white beans
3 tablespoons canola oil
¾ cup brown sugar
½ cup granulated sugar
¼ cup egg substitute or 1 egg
1 teaspoon vanilla
3 cups oats
1 cup whole wheat flour
1 teaspoon salt
½ teaspoon soda

Optional add-ins:
Chopped nuts
Chocolate chips
Coconut flakes
Dried fruit

1. Preheat oven to 350ºF. Beat mashed white beans, oil, brown sugar, granulated sugar, egg substitute or egg, and vanilla until smooth and creamy.
2. Combine the remaining dry ingredients in a separate bowl and mix together. Add to the bean and sugar mixture and mix well. Add chopped nuts and chocolate chips if desired.
3. Drop onto greased cookie sheets and bake for 8-10 minutes. Cool on cookie sheet for 5 minutes then transfer to wire rack and cool completely. Recipe makes about 36 cookies.

Recipe adapted from Heidi Wengreen

Cinnamon Oranges

This Moroccan dessert couldn't be simpler, and the result is really delicious!

Oranges, as many as you'd like
Ground cinnamon

1. Peel the oranges and slice into wheels about ¼ inch thick. Place in a bowl.
2. Sprinkle cinnamon lightly over the oranges and stir to combine. Add more or less cinnamon as desired and serve immediately.

Pineapple Orange Frozen Yogurt

Ice cream is delicious, but this frozen yogurt alternative is just as tasty! Play around with this recipe and see what other combinations you can come up with using your favorite fruits and different flavors of yogurt.

1 1/3 cup plain yogurt
1/3 cup orange juice
1 cup pineapple chunks, fresh or canned

1. Place yogurt and fruit in large plastic bag, flatten, and freeze for at least 6 hours, preferably overnight. If you are using pineapple already frozen, don't worry about adding it to the bag.
2. Combine all ingredients in a blender or food processer and blend until smooth.
3. Serve immediately or place in freezer for up to an hour stirring occasionally so that it doesn't get too stiff. Stir before serving. Serves about 4.

Recipe adapted from whatscooking.fns.usda.gov

